

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

Flash flood

NATURAL HAZARDS / EDITION 2026-10-02

QUICK ANSWER / START HERE

Move to higher ground immediately if a flash-flood warning affects you or water is rising. Never cross flowing water on foot or in a vehicle. Leave low areas, canyons and basements without waiting to see how high the water gets.

Do now.

**Get uphill**

01

Move away from streams, low roads and drainage channels.

**Turn around**

02

Do not drive across a flooded road; the roadbed may be missing.

**If trapped**

03

Call emergency services and move to a higher open level without becoming trapped in a closed attic.

**Follow routes**

04

Use current evacuation and road-closure instructions.

Keep the plan moving.

IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Move uphill before the route fills; leave belongings behind. If trapped above floodwater, remain in a safe elevated position and signal your location. Do not attempt to swim a current or enter water to rescue property.

Watch for.

A small-looking current can sweep away people and vehicles.

People & practical needs.

Plan a route that avoids low crossings and can be used by everyone. Carry children only within the helper's real ability and do not attempt improvised water rescues

Next decision.

Wait for official clearance. Water may rise after rain stops or when storms occur upstream.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Flash flood · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/flash-flood/>